

ZENITH ORBITAL SYSTEMS

Cybersecurity Incident Response Plan

Effective: March 22, 2026 | Next Review: March 2027 | Version 1.0

Prepared by: Noe Valencia, PSSE

Derived from SANS Institute Cybersecurity Sample Policies and Public Domain Sources

1. Goals for Cyber Incident Response

When a cybersecurity incident occurs, timely and thorough action to manage its impact is critical to an effective response. The response must limit potential damage by ensuring actions are well known, coordinated, and executed consistently. The goals of this plan are:

1. Preserve and protect the confidentiality of employee and constituent information, and ensure the integrity and availability of all ZOS organizational systems, networks, and data.
2. Help ZOS personnel recover their business processes following a computer or network security incident or data breach.
3. Provide a consistent, repeatable response strategy to system and network threats that put ZOS data and systems at risk.
4. Develop and activate a communications plan including initial reporting of the incident and ongoing communications as necessary throughout the response lifecycle.
5. Address cyber-related legal issues including regulatory notification obligations, contractual requirements, and potential law enforcement engagement.
6. Coordinate efforts with external Computer Incident Response Teams, forensic vendors, and law enforcement as appropriate.
7. Minimize ZOS reputational risk through controlled, timely, and accurate communications.

2. Purpose and Scope

This plan provides practical guidelines for responding to cybersecurity and data breach incidents in a consistent and effective manner. It establishes a team of first responders known as the Incident Response Team (IRT), with defined roles, responsibilities, and communication protocols.

While this plan is primarily oriented around cyber-related incidents and breaches, it may also be utilized for data breaches not directly related to computer systems, such as physical theft of records or inadvertent disclosure of printed materials.

This plan applies to all ZOS personnel, systems, and data. All employees, contractors, and third-party service providers with access to ZOS organizational systems are subject to this plan and must cooperate fully with the IRT during an active incident.

3. Incident Response Team (IRT)

A team comprised of ZOS staff, advisors, and service providers shall be responsible for coordinating incident responses. The IRT shall consist of both primary and secondary members. Primary members act as first responders and are engaged based on the severity of the incident. The entire team is activated for the most severe incidents.

There shall be a designated Incident Response Manager (IRM) who takes on organizational and coordination leadership of the IRT during an active incident. The IRM serves as the single point of coordination for all response activities. IRT members may take on additional roles during an incident as needed.

The IRT will draw upon Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) including IT staff, forensic vendors, legal counsel, and public relations advisors as required. Huntress serves as ZOS's AI-powered managed detection and response (MDR) provider and is a key SME for technical analysis, threat hunting, and initial containment guidance. When a threat is detected, Huntress AI automatically isolates the affected endpoint from the network, preventing the threat from spreading laterally to other systems or causing further damage while the IRT coordinates its full response.

3.1 Primary IRT Members

Role / Assigned To	Primary Responsibilities
Head of IT / IRM: Noe Valencia	Discover and verify incidents; notify IRT; coordinate forensic and technical remediation; apply corrective actions to infrastructure; maintain proactive cybersecurity posture; serve as single point of coordination during active incidents
Director of Mission Assurance: Michael R. Torres	Executive oversight of all incident response activities; mission impact assessment; board and client communications during severe incidents
General Counsel: Gregory A. Whitfield	Legal advisor; regulatory compliance; contractual matters; law enforcement liaison; PII breach notification obligations
HR and Communications Director: Sandra L. Pham	Manage public relations, news media, and all external and internal communications during an incident; employee data exposure notifications
Chief Financial Officer: Rachel M. Okafor	Assess financial impact and financial data exposure; authorize emergency expenditures for incident response; coordinate cyber insurance claims

Orbital Systems Security Analyst: Carlos E. Mendoza	Technical threat analysis; threat hunting; containment support; forensic evidence preservation
Physical Security Manager: Daniel J. Kowalski	Manage building access control and physical security during an incident; coordinate with law enforcement on physical aspects

3.2 Secondary IRT Members

Role / Vendor	Primary Responsibilities
Huntress (MDR Provider)	AI-powered threat detection; automatically quarantines affected endpoints upon threat detection to prevent lateral movement and network spread; technical mitigation and digital forensics support; 24/7 SOC coverage
Legal Counsel (External)	External legal advisor; regulatory compliance oversight; law enforcement liaison for criminal investigations; contract and liability matters
Public Relations Vendor	External public relations advisor during and after significant incidents affecting ZOS client or public communications
Cyber Insurance Provider	Cyber insurance advisor; claims coordination; coverage guidance; pre-breach planning consultation

4. Incident Response Lifecycle

Cyber incident response management is an ongoing process with a cyclical pattern. Each phase builds on the previous, and lessons learned from any incident are fed back into the preparation phase to continuously improve ZOS's response capabilities.

Phase	Description
1. Preparation	The ongoing process of maintaining and improving incident response capabilities and preventing incidents through secure systems, employee awareness training, and periodic tabletop exercises. Huntress provides continuous AI-powered threat detection and MDR as part of the preparation and monitoring posture. When a threat is detected, Huntress automatically quarantines the

	affected endpoint. Preparation is the only phase that occurs before an incident and never stops.
2. Identification	The process of confirming, characterizing, classifying, categorizing, scoping, and prioritizing suspected incidents. This phase determines whether an event is a true incident and establishes its type, impact, and severity.
3. Notification	Alerting IRT members to the occurrence of a confirmed incident and communicating status throughout the response. Communication channels, escalation paths, and notification timing are governed by the incident severity level.
4. Containment	Minimizing financial and reputational loss, theft of information, or service disruption. Includes initial public communications and legal notifications as required. The goal is to stop the bleeding without destroying forensic evidence. Huntress AI assists containment by automatically quarantining the affected endpoint the moment a threat is confirmed.
5. Eradication	Eliminating the threat from all affected systems. This includes removing malware, closing unauthorized access paths, patching exploited vulnerabilities, and resetting compromised credentials across the environment.
6. Recovery	Restoring systems and business operations to normal, verified clean states. Includes reputational repair, customer communications, credit monitoring for affected individuals, and legal remediation as appropriate.
7. Post-Incident	After recovery, formalize documentation of the incident, conduct lessons learned review with the full IRT, and apply learnings to future preparedness and update this plan accordingly.

5. Incident Occurrence and Awareness

The way an incident becomes known will have an impact on the response process and its urgency. Incidents may be discovered through any of the following channels:

1. ZOS discovers through its internal monitoring such as Huntress AI detection, Splunk SIEM alerts, or IDS/IPS notifications that a cyber incident or data breach

has occurred. Huntress will automatically quarantine the affected machine and notify IT immediately.

- 2. ZOS is notified by one of its technology providers, cloud service providers, or managed security service providers of an incident or potential breach.
- 3. ZOS is made aware of a breach through a constituent, customer, employee, or third-party informant who observed or was affected by suspicious activity.
- 4. ZOS and the public are made aware of the incident through news media, public disclosure, or regulatory notification from a third party affected by the same incident.

Regardless of the discovery channel, all suspected incidents must be reported immediately to the Head of Information Technology or the Incident Response Manager. No ZOS employee should attempt to investigate or respond to a suspected incident independently without notifying the IRT.

6. Incident Response Process Detail

Phase / Timing / Steps	Involved Parties
IDENTIFICATION (Hours): 1. Identify and confirm whether the suspected or reported incident has occurred and whether malicious activity is still underway. 2. Determine the type, impact, and severity per the matrix in Section 8. 3. If Huntress has already automatically quarantined the affected endpoint, verify the quarantine is active and confirm no other systems are impacted before proceeding with additional containment.	IT, Huntress (AI detection), and any monitoring service provider
NOTIFICATION (Hours to 1 Day): 4. Inform or activate the IRT based on incident severity as defined in Section 8.	IT and IRT

Provide incident type, impact, and all known details. 5. Determine whether Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) are required for Containment, Eradication, or Recovery.	
CONTAINMENT (Hours to 2 Days): 6. Take immediate steps to curtail ongoing malicious activity or prevent repetition. Note: Huntress auto-quarantine may have already isolated the affected system automatically. 7. Redirect public-facing websites if needed. 8. Provide initial public relations and legal responses as required.	IRT, IT, Huntress, SMEs
ERADICATION (Days to Weeks): 9. Provide full technical resolution of the threat and all related malicious activity. 10. Address public relations, regulatory notification, and legal issues. 11. Reset all compromised credentials and patch all exploited vulnerabilities.	IT, IRT, SMEs
RECOVERY (Weeks to Months): 12. Recover any business process disruptions and restore normal operations. 13.	SMEs, IRT

Address longer-term public relations or legal issues. 14. Apply constituent remedies such as credit monitoring or notification letters as required.	IRT
POST-INCIDENT (Months): 15. Formalize documentation of the incident including a complete incident timeline. 16. Conduct lessons learned review with the full IRT. 17. Apply learnings to future preparedness and update this plan accordingly.	

7. Communication Methods

ZOS organizational communication resources including email and phone systems may be compromised or unavailable during a severe incident. Primary and alternate out-of-band communication methods using external infrastructure must be established before any incident occurs and documented on the IRT member contact list. The IRM will designate which communication method will be used at the outset of any activated incident response.

Communication Method	Purpose and Usage
Organizational email (primary)	Standard day-to-day use; may be unavailable during severe incidents
Personal mobile phones (backup)	Out-of-band communication when ZOS organizational systems are unavailable
Encrypted messaging app (Signal)	Secure out-of-band communication for sensitive incident details during active response
Conference bridge (external)	IRT coordination calls when internal phone systems are unavailable

In-person meeting

Primary method for Severity 4 and 5 incidents where electronic systems cannot be trusted

8. Information Recording

Information recording is critical during an incident not only for effective containment and eradication, but also for post-incident lessons learned and any legal action that may follow. Accurate, timestamped records can be essential evidence in law enforcement investigations and regulatory inquiries.

Each member of the IRT is responsible for recording information and chronological references about their actions and findings during an incident using the IRT Incident Record Form in Appendix E of this plan. Records must include:

- Date and time of each action or observation
- Name of the individual recording the entry
- System, account, or data set affected
- Actions taken and their outcomes, including any Huntress automated actions such as endpoint quarantine
- Any communications made or received related to the incident

Incident records are considered confidential and legally sensitive. They must be stored securely and access restricted to IRT members and authorized legal counsel only.

9. Incident Response Exercises

The ZOS IRT must conduct tabletop exercises to practice the response process on a periodic basis, at minimum annually, so all members are familiar with their responsibilities and the coordination required during an actual incident. Exercises should be conducted every six months per Databarracks best practice guidance.

Tabletop exercises present realistic incident scenarios to the team in a practice setting without actual systems being affected. They provide the opportunity to identify gaps in the plan, test communication procedures, and improve team coordination. Common scenarios to exercise include:

- Ransomware attack encrypting ZOS ground station servers and triggering a Huntress automated quarantine
- Data breach involving PII exfiltration from ZOS HR systems
- DDoS attack against ZOS internet-facing satellite data relay API
- Insider threat accessing sensitive mission telemetry data without authorization
- Phishing campaign resulting in compromised executive credentials
- Physical breach of the MDF room or IDF closet
- Loss of ground-to-space link continuity requiring BCP activation

Lessons identified from exercises must be documented and incorporated into this plan and the organization's security controls. The IRM is responsible for scheduling, facilitating, and documenting all exercises.

10. Appendix A: IRT Incident Severity and Response Classification Matrix

Level	Typical Characteristics	Example Impact	Response Actions	Activate IRT?
5	DDoS against servers. Active attacks on network infrastructure. Access to internal data by unauthorized parties.	Enterprise-wide attack across multiple departments. Prevents access to systems. Theft of proprietary data.	IRT and IRM direct full response. Huntress MDR notified immediately; auto-quarantine verified. IT, Forensics, and SMEs coordinate remediation. Law enforcement and Legal Counsel engaged.	Full Team Active
4	Affects data or services for a group. Threatens sensitive data. Involves elevated privilege accounts.	Compromised business application. Improper or unauthorized access to data.	IRM, IT, Huntress (MDR), and SMEs coordinate response. Full IRT advised. Legal Counsel notified if PII breach.	Full Team Informed and Advised
3	Affects a single individual with significant sensitive data. May include PII.	Employee computer or account with sensitive data access compromised. Physical theft of device.	IT or IRM coordinates. Huntress auto-quarantine checked and confirmed if triggered. IRT members informed. Legal Counsel notified if PII breach.	Primary Team Informed

2	Affects a group with no sensitive data involved.	Compromise of an account or shared folder with no sensitive data.	IT coordinates response. IRM advised, IRT informed. Huntress portal reviewed for related alerts. IT documentation records findings.	Primary Team Informed
1	Affects a single individual with no sensitive data. Focus is correction and prevention.	Compromised computer with no sensitive data.	Documentation of issue and findings. IT/IRM coordinate remediation.	No
0	Very minor or undetermined incident with no practical follow-up needed.	Impaired computer requiring AV scan or password reset.	Documentation through normal IT support processes. Reset passwords as needed.	No

11. Appendix B: IRT Member Contact List

Contact information for all IRT members must be maintained, circulated to the team, and stored both digitally and in printed form. The printed copy must be stored securely off-system in the biometric safe in the ZOS MDF room in case digital systems are unavailable during an incident.

Name / Role	Contact Information
Noe Valencia, Head of IT / IRM	Work: (214) 555-0147 Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: noe.valencia.alt@zos-secure.com
Michael R. Torres, Director of Mission Assurance	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]
Gregory A. Whitfield, General Counsel	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]

Sandra L. Pham, HR and Communications Director	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]
Rachel M. Okafor, CFO	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]
Carlos E. Mendoza, Orbital Systems Security Analyst	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]
Daniel J. Kowalski, Ground Systems IT Manager / Physical Security	Work: [Work Phone] Mobile: [Mobile] Alt Email: [Alt Email]
Huntress MDR (External SME)	Portal: [Huntress Portal] Hotline: [Hotline] support@huntress.com
External Legal Counsel	[Law Firm] [Phone] [Mobile] [Email]
Cyber Insurance Provider	[Insurance Provider] [Phone] [Email]

12. Appendix C: IRT Incident Record Form

Each IRT member must use this form to record all actions, observations, and communications during an active incident. Accuracy and timestamps are critical for post-incident analysis and any potential legal proceedings. Include any automated actions taken by Huntress such as endpoint quarantine events.

Field	Entry
Incident Designation	
Discovery Date	
Severity Level	
Recorded By	
IRT Role	

Date / Time	Recorded Information and Events

13. Sources and References

- SANS Institute Cybersecurity Incident Response Plan Template. <https://www.sans.org/information-security-policy/>
- NIST SP 800-61 Rev 2, Computer Security Incident Handling Guide. <https://csrc.nist.gov>
- CISA Incident Response Guidance. <https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/incident-response-guide>
- Databarracks Business Continuity and Incident Response best practices. <https://www.databarracks.com>
- Huntress MDR Platform Documentation. <https://www.huntress.com>